

Rare and Complex Epilepsies in Australia

From system gaps to a connected response

1 in 590

Australian children are affected by a Developmental and Epileptic Encephalopathy — a Rare and Complex Epilepsy. (Poke et al., 2022)

Rare and Complex Epilepsies are typically folded into the broader category of epilepsy. Families are not falling through gaps in one system — they are falling through gaps in every system, and none of these systems can meet their needs in isolation.

THE ASK

Australia must establish a national organisation with the authority, representation and capability to lead the sector — the National Rare and Complex Epilepsies Collaborative.

55

attendees at the Roundtable

34

organisations represented

1 May 2026

Roundtable held in Brisbane

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The Problem

No single system can meet families' needs in isolation; progress depends on individual champions, not system design.

2

Scope of the Challenge

DEEs are lifelong, multi-system conditions affecting roughly 1 in 590 Australian children.

3

Consequences of Fragmentation

Delayed diagnosis, inconsistent care, and inequitable access to emerging therapies.

4

Shared Vision

A National Rare and Complex Epilepsies Collaborative, connecting people, evidence and action.

5

Sector Consensus

Strong agreement for an independent national organisation with multi-stakeholder governance.

6

DEE Roundtable Priorities

An indicative roadmap to national impact, sequenced with the sector.

7

Next Phase

From consensus to action: governance, funding and government engagement.

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